Pooya Molavi

curriculum vitae

Kellogg School of Management
Northwestern University
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Academic Positions

Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University

2026– Associate Professor of Managerial Economics & Decision Sciences (without tenure)

2020–26 Assistant Professor of Managerial Economics & Decision Sciences

Department of Economics, Northwestern University

2020– Courtesy appointment

Becker Friedman Institute, University of Chicago

2019–20 Saieh Family Fellow in Economics

Education

2019 Ph.D., Economics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2013 Ph.D., Electrical and Systems Engineering, University of Pennsylvania

2010 M.S.E., Electrical Engineering, University of Pennsylvania

2008 B.S., Electrical Engineering, Sharif University of Technology, Tehran, Iran

Publications

"Model Complexity, Expectations, and Asset Prices," with Alireza Tahbaz-Salehi and Andrea Vedolin, *Review of Economic Studies*, 91(4): 2462–2507, 2024.

"A Theory of Non-Bayesian Social Learning," with Alireza Tahbaz-Salehi and Ali Jadbabaie, *Econometrica*, 86(2): 445–490, 2018.

"Learning to Coordinate in Social Networks," with Ceyhun Eksin, Alejandro Ribeiro, and Ali Jadbabaie, *Operations Research*, 64(3): 605–621, 2016.

"Bayesian Quadratic Network Game Filters," with Ceyhun Eksin, Alejandro Ribeiro, and Ali Jadbabaie, *IEEE Transactions on Signal Processing*, 62(9): 2250–2264, 2014.

"Non-Bayesian Social Learning," with Ali Jadbabaie, Alvaro Sandroni, and Alireza Tahbaz-Salehi, *Games and Economic Behavior*, 76(1): 210–225, 2012.

Working Papers

"The Empirical Content of Bayesian Updating under Misspecification," revise and resubmit, *Econometrica*, 2026.

"Censorship and Repression," with Arda Gitmez and Konstantin Sonin, revise and resubmit, *Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics*, 2025.

"Learning and the Emergence of Nonlinearity in Financial Markets," with Ian Dew-Becker and Stefano Giglio, 2026.

"Expectations and the Term Structure of Interest Rates," with Alireza Tahbaz-Salehi and Andrea Vedolin, 2026.

"Using Density Forecasts to Measure the Stability of Inflation Expectations," with Ian Dew-Becker and Stefano Giglio, 2026.

"Simple Models and Biased Forecasts," 2025.

"Macroeconomics with Learning and Misspecification: A General Theory and Applications," 2019.

"A Theory of Dynamic Selection in the Labor Market," 2018.

Teaching

Northwestern University

MECS-560-2: Dynamic Optimization in Economics (PhD, 2020–)

MECN-430-0: Microeconomic Analysis (MBA, 2022–)

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

14.02: Principles of Macroeconomics (Instructor, 2015; TA, 2018)

14.03/14.003: Microeconomic Theory & Public Policy (TA, 2017)

14.04: Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (TA, 2015, 2017)

14.05: Intermediate Macroeconomics (TA, 2019)

14.15/6.207: Networks (TA, 2019)

14.18: Mathematical Economic Modeling (TA, 2016)

University of Pennsylvania

ESE 504-402: Introduction to Optimization Theory (TA, 2009)

ESE 605: Modern Convex Optimization (TA, 2010)

Fellowships, Awards, and Honors

2019 UniCredit Best Paper Award, Copenhagen Macro Days.

2019 *Review of Economic Studies* European Tour.

2016 Neekeyfar Fund Award, Office of Graduate Education, MIT.

2013–15 Department of Economics Graduate Fellowship, MIT.

2008–13 Department of Electrical and Systems Engineering Graduate Fellowship, UPenn.

2003 Gold Medal, 16^{th} Iranian National Physics Olympiad.

Seminars and Conference Presentations

2026 UVA, UT Austin Spring Macro Conference, Learning and Bounded Rationality (Kellogg), PHBS International Workshop in Macroeconomics and Finance, SED (Athens), SITE (Dynamic Games, Contracts, and Markets), Transatlantic Theory Workshop (Northwestern), Virtual Asian Seminar Series on Expectations in Macroeconomics.

2025 AEA meetings (San Francisco), HKU Macroeconomics Workshop, FIRS (Seoul), CEPR conference on Beliefs and the Macroeconomy (National Bank of Belgium), SED (Copenhagen), EFA (Paris), University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee, San Francisco Fed, CUHK–CEPR Workshop on Imperfect Expectations and Bounded Rationality, University of Macau.

2024 AEA meetings (San Antonio), Barcelona Summer Forum (Preferences, Bounded Rationality, and Strategic Interactions), SED (Barcelona), Transatlantic Theory Workshop (PSE), Saieh Family Fellows Conference (UChicago).

2023 AEA meetings (New Orleans), Stony Brook University, North America Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society (UCLA), Learning and Bounded Rationality Workshop (Stony Brook), Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society (Singapore), Information and Expectations in Macroeconomics Workshop (St. Louis Fed).

2022 Brown, Northwestern–UChicago Economic Theory Conference, Finance Theory Group Summer Meeting (Budapest), Pizzanomics Conference (EIEF), NBER Summer Institute (Impulse and Propagation Mechanisms), SITE (Dynamic Games, Contracts, and Markets), Econometric Society European Meeting (Milan), European Finance Association (Barcelona), Chicago Fed, Toronto Junior Finance/Macro Conference, Purdue.

2021 AEA meetings (Chicago), UConn, UC Berkeley, SED (Minneapolis), Aalto, Saieh Family Fellows Conference (UChicago), Northwestern, City University of Hong Kong.

2020 Econometric Society North American Winter Meetings (San Diego), UChicago, World Congress of the Econometric Society (Bocconi), Northwestern, Cornell, Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (New Orleans), Econometric Society European Winter Meeting (Nottingham).

2019 Princeton, Minnesota, Harvard, NYU, Yale, UChicago, Northwestern Kellogg, Chicago Booth, Penn State, Columbia GSB, LSE, KU Leuven, SciencesPo, Copenhagen Macro Days (University of Copenhagen), SED (St. Louis), Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory, SITE (Dynamic Games, Contracts, and Markets), Emerging Scholars Conference (University of Wisconsin–Madison), Transatlantic Theory Workshop (Oxford), Duke, Hong Kong University, Chinese University of Hong Kong, UCLA, UC Irvine, CREI–UPF, CEMFI, Carnegie Mellon.

2018 MIT, Minneapolis Fed Junior Scholar Conference.

2016 Workshop on Information and Social Economics (Caltech).

Professional Activities

Referee AER, QJE, JPE, Econometrica, REStud, AER: Insights, Journal of Financial Economics, Theoretical Economics, JET, AEJ: Micro, Games and Economic Behavior, International Economic Review, Management Science, Operations Research.

Program committee European Economic Association (2021).